# Backtest: prove a routine on past days before you trust it

A backtest replays past days with practice money: the real bot, its real settings, the real candles, but nothing is ordered. This tab has three tools: backtest the day's strong-trend picks by themselves, compare pick times side by side, and rank your stocks by how well your strategy did on each of them.

**Why backtest at all**

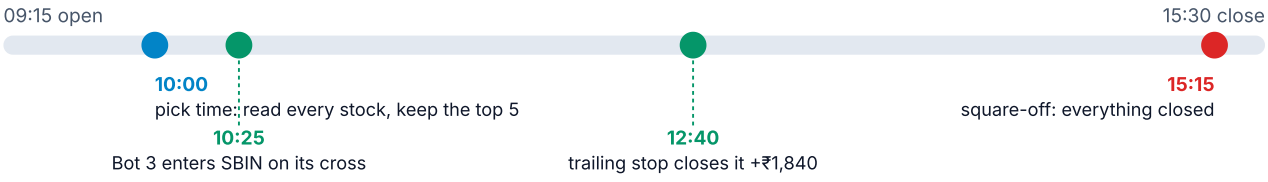
A trading idea feels right on the one day you watched it. A backtest asks the same question on 10 or 20 days you did not watch, and gives you numbers: how often it won, how much it made, how bad the worst stretch was. If the idea fails on past days, it has no business with your money today.

## 1. The three tools on this tab

| TOOL | WHAT IT DOES | WHEN TO USE IT |
|---|---|---|
| **Strong-trend picks** | On each past day, at the pick time you choose, every stock in your lists is read as the Trend quality card would have read it then (the same 7 checks, only the candles closed by that minute). The strong bullish / bearish ones are ranked and the top N become that day's picks. The bot you choose trades only them, from the pick minute to the square-off, with its own settings. | To test the routine "at 10:00 take the top 5 strong trends". |
| **Compare pick times** | The same test run 2-8 times with different pick times (09:20 to 14:30), then shown side by side: P&L, trades, win %, green days, best / worst day, biggest drop, and which time did best on most days. | To find the time of day the routine works best. |
| **Which stocks does my strategy win on?** | A bot's own settings backtested on every stock you pick over the same past days, then each stock ranked: trades, win %, green days, ₹ before and after charges, profit factor, and a verdict. | Every week or two, to keep the stocks that suit the strategy and drop the rest. |

All three use the bot's **replay player**, the same engine that trades the live desk. That is the point: a backtest here is the real bot on the real candles, not a rough arithmetic.

## 2. One backtest day, in a picture



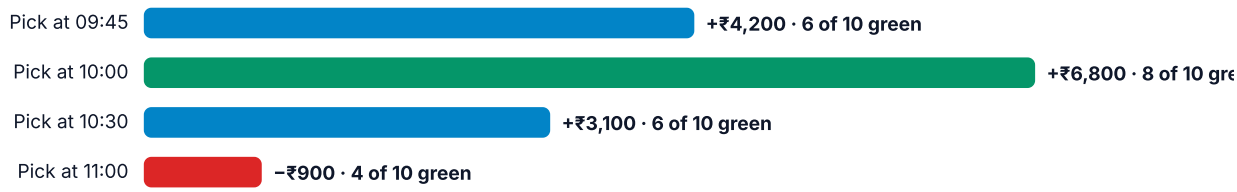

Every past day is played this way, one after another, at full speed. The trades go into the Backtests tab of the terminal.

A strong-trend pick day: nothing is traded before the pick time; after it the bot trades the picks with its own settings until the square-off.

## 3. The numbers, in plain words

| NUMBER | MEANING | WHAT IS GOOD |
|---|---|---|
| P&L (before charges) | What the trades made in ₹ before brokerage and taxes. The screens show this figure. | Positive, and still positive **after charges**. |
| After charges | The same minus Groww's intraday charges on every trade. | Many small wins turn into a loss here: always look. |
| Trades / Win % | How many trades, and the share that made money. | Win % alone misleads: 40 % can be fine with big wins and small losses. |
| Green days | Days that ended with a profit, e.g. 7 of 10. | A rule that wins on most days is easier to live with. |
| Per day / Best day / Worst day | The average day, and the two extremes. | A best day much bigger than the rest means one lucky day carried the result. |
| Biggest drop | The largest fall of the running total from a high to the next low: the worst stretch you would have sat through. | Small compared with the total profit. |
| Profit factor (won ÷ lost) | All the money won divided by all the money lost. 1.0 = break-even. | 1.5 or more is good; under 1.2 is weak. |
| Avg return / trade | The average trade's result as a % of its value (qty × entry price). | Over about 0.3 % to clear charges. |
| Verdict (stock ranking) | **Strong**: profit factor ≥ 1.5 and ≥ 55 % green days. **Good**: ≥ 1.2. **Weak**: profitable but thin. **Avoid**: lost money. **Few**: under 5 trades or 3 days, not enough to judge. | Keep Strong and Good; re-run every week or two. |

## 4. Compare pick times: a picture




Four pick times, the same 10 days, stocks, bot and settings. 10:00 made the most and was green on the most days; 11:00 lost. Later picks catch trends that are already tired.

## 5. How to use it




1. **Strong-trend picks**: choose the stock lists, how many past days (10-20), the pick time, the direction, top N, the candle and the bot. Keep **Play hand-offs** ticked if that bot's Settings move stocks to Bot 2 / Bot 3: the backtest then plays those moves too. Press **Backtest** and watch the replay bar on the terminal.

2. Read the finished run in the terminal's **Backtests** tab (trades, day-wise P&L, the PDF). The picks of each day are saved on the run.
3. **Compare pick times**: tick 2-8 times and press Compare. Read the **answer lines** first (which time made the most, on how many days it was best), then the day-by-day table. A warning says when the bot's settings changed between the runs or there are under 10 days.
4. **Which stocks does my strategy win on?**: pick the lists, days and the bot's strategy, press **Rank**. Keep the Strong and Good ones (Show → keep); tick them and **Arm ticked**. Nothing is armed until you press it.
5. Tick **Every trading day, by itself** → On: after each close the server backtests that day's picks and the report builds up without you pressing anything.

## 6. A worked example

Nifty 100, last 10 days, pick at 10:00, top 5 strong trends, Bot 3 (the trend bot). Result: +₹6,800 before charges, +₹4,900 after, 38 trades, win 47 %, 8 of 10 green days, biggest drop ₹1,600, profit factor 1.7. The worst day (−₹1,100) was a budget day. Compare pick times says 10:00 beat 09:45, 10:30 and 11:00. Stock ranking on the same days: BEL and HAL Strong, SBIN Good, ITC Avoid (it lost on 6 of 8 days). So: arm BEL, HAL and SBIN on Bot 3, keep the 10:00 Scan & arm schedule, drop ITC, and re-rank in two weeks.

**Before you trust it**
Ten days is the minimum, twenty is better. A result carried by one big day is luck, not a rule. Charges turn many small wins into a loss: judge the **after charges** figure. And a backtest fills at the candle's prices with no slippage, so the live result will be a little worse.

## 7. Benefits and limits

### Why it helps

- Turns "I think 10:00 is the best time" into numbers on your own stocks and days.
- The real bot plays it, with its real stop, trail, exits and hand-offs.
- The daily run builds a track record by itself.

### Limits

- Past days are not tomorrow; a rule that worked for a month can stop.
- No slippage, and the practice fills are a little kind.
- Practice money only; nothing here places an order, and arming is a separate button.

## 8. Words used here

**Backtest / replay**
Playing past days through the real bot with practice money.

**Pick time**
The minute of the day at which the stocks are read and chosen.

**Top N**
How many of the ranked stocks become that day's picks.

**Play hand-offs**

Let the bot's own rules move a stock to Bot 2 (chop) or Bot 3 (trend) inside the backtest.

**Green day**

A day that ended with a profit.

**Biggest drop (drawdown)**

The worst fall of the running total from a high to the next low.

**Profit factor**

Money won ÷ money lost; 1.5 means ₹1.50 won for every ₹1 lost.

**Verdict**

Strong / Good / Weak / Avoid / Few: the stock ranking's one-word summary per stock.

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Practice money and candles only: nothing on the Scalp page places an order. The bots trade only the stocks you arm, in PAPER (practice) mode unless you switch one to LIVE yourself.